

Haowen Zheng

Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics, University of Michigan
E-mail: zhenghw@umich.edu

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI

Postdoctoral Fellow, Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics

Project: "Workplace Income Distribution by Social Class in the United States Manufacturing Sector, 1967-2022."

PIs: Pablo Mitnik and Tali Kristal

EDUCATION

Cornell University, Ithaca, NY

Ph.D., in Sociology, 2025

M.A., Sociology, 2021

Minor in Demography, 2021

New York University, New York City, NY

M.A., Applied Quantitative Research, 2019

Beijing Foreign Studies University, Beijing, China

B.A., English Language and Literature, 2017

Visiting student, Barnard College, Columbia University, 2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social Stratification & Mobility, Gender, Spatial Demography, Quantitative & Computational Methods

Dissertation:

The Geography of Stratification and Constrained Migration: Uneven Opportunities and Spatial Sorting in U.S. Labor Markets

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Zheng, Haowen. "Diverging Trajectories: Gendered Income Dynamics Pre- and Post-Family Migration"

[Accepted] *Demographic Research*

- ASA Sociology of Population Student Paper Award Honorable Mention
- Kerckhoff Award, Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility (RC28)

- Robin M. Williams, Jr. Best Paper Award, Cornell sociology department (given annually for the best graduate student paper)

Zheng, Haowen, Robert Andersen, Anders Holm, and Kristian B. Karlson. 2026. "Is College Really 'the' Equalizer: New Evidence Addressing Unobserved Selection" *Sociological Science* 13: 242-272 [\[Open access link\]](#)[\[Replication package\]](#)

Zheng, Haowen, Siwei Cheng. 2025. "Social Rigidity Across and Within Generations: A Predictive Approach" *Sociological Methods and Research*, 54(4), 1683-1725 [\[Online first\]](#)[\[Replication package\]](#)

Zheng, Haowen, Kim A. Weeden. 2023. "How Gender Segregation in Higher Education Contributes to Gender Segregation in the U.S. Labor Market" *Demography*, 60(3), 761-784. [\[Open access link\]](#)[\[Replication package\]](#)[Media coverage: [Cornell Chronicle](#)]

Zheng, Haowen. 2020. "The Only-child Premium and Moderation by Social Origin: Educational Stratification in Post-reform China." *Chinese Journal of Sociology*, 6(3): 384-409. [\[Open access link\]](#)

- Master's Award for Academic Achievement in the Social Sciences, New York University

OTHER WRITING

Zheng, Haowen. "Why 'Equal Pay for Equal Work' Doesn't Work: The Persistence of Gender Segregation in Occupations." (Invited book chapter, in preparation, in *Women and Work: History, Issues, Trends*, edited by S.M. Jones. NYC: Bloomsbury USA.)

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2025	ASA Student Forum Travel Award
	ASA Sociology of Population Student Paper Award Honorable Mention
	Excellence in Teaching, Cornell Sociology department
2024	Robin M. Williams, Jr. Best Paper Award, Cornell Sociology department
	Kerckhoff Award (RC28)
2023, 2019	Sage Fellowship, Cornell University
2023	NYU-Shanghai CISER Computational Social Science Institute Scholarship
	Cornell University Sociology Department Workshop Grant
2022-2025	Cornell Population Center Travel Grant
	Cornell University Graduate School Travel Grant
	Cornell University Sociology Department Travel Grant
	Center for the Study of Inequality Graduate Student Travel Award

2019	Center for the Study of Inequality Graduate Fellowship, Cornell University Master's Award for Academic Achievement in the Social Sciences, New York University
2018	Data Science for Social Good Summer Fellowship, University of Washington
2017	Outstanding Undergraduate Student Thesis Award, Beijing Foreign Studies University

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

Zheng, Haowen. "Occupational Restructuring and the Decline of Internal Migration by College Status, 1980-2019"

- RC28 Summer Meeting, UCLA, August 2025
- The 17th Annual Sociology Research Symposium, Cornell University, March 2025
- Center for the Study of Inequality Discussion Group, Cornell University, March 2025

Zheng, Haowen. "How Demographic Changes Drive Internal Migration Decline Among Heterosexual Couples: A Cohort-Based Approach"

- American Sociological Association Annual Conference, Chicago, August 2025

Zheng, Haowen, Robert Andersen, Anders Holm, and Kristian B. Karlson. "Is College Really 'the' Equalizer: New Evidence from Models that Correct for Unobserved Heterogeneity"

- American Sociological Association Annual Conference, Chicago, August 2025
- The 2nd Annual Sociological Science Conference, Cornell University, June 2025
- Population Association of America Annual Meeting, Washington DC, April 2025

Zheng, Haowen. "Competitive Income Trajectories: Gender Inequality in the Life Course Effects of Family Migration among Married Couples"

- American Sociological Association Annual Conference, Montreal, Canada, August 2024
- RC28 Spring Meeting, Shanghai, China, May 2024
- Center for the Study of Inequality Discussion Group, Cornell University, April 2024

Zheng, Haowen, Siwei Cheng, "Social Rigidity Across and Within Generations: A Predictive Approach"

- New Methods to Measure Intergenerational Mobility Conference, University of Chicago, Nov 2023
- American Sociological Association Annual Conference, Philadelphia, PA, August 2023
- Center for the Study of Inequality Discussion Group, Cornell University, March 2023

Zheng, Haowen, Kim A. Weeden, "How gender segregation in higher education contributes to gender segregation in the U.S. labor market"

- Population Association of America Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA, April 2022

- Center for the Study of Inequality Discussion Group, Cornell University, August 2021
- International conference “Rethinking gender: Economic and social costs of gender inequality” Kyiv School of Economics. Virtual. April 2021

Zheng, Haowen, “The Only-child Premium and Moderation by Social Origin: Educational Stratification in Post-reform China,” ICSA (International Chinese Sociological Association) Annual Conference, New York City, NY, August 2019

TEACHING & MENTORING

Spring 2025 Excellence in Teaching, Cornell Sociology department
Teaching Assistant, Social Inequality (undergraduate), Prof. Kim Weeden

Fall 2024 Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Sociology (undergraduate), Prof. Joseph Sullivan

Spring 2023 Guest lecturer, Studying Social Inequality with Data Science (undergraduate), Prof. Ian Lundberg

Spring 2023 Course Design Institute Certificate, Center for Teaching Innovation, Cornell University

2023 – 2024 Student mentor for a first-year graduate student at Cornell Sociology

Fall 2022 Teaching Assistant, Controversies about inequalities (undergraduate), Prof. Joseph Sullivan

2021 – 2022 Student mentor for a first-year graduate student at Cornell sociology

Spring 2022 Active Learning Institute Certificate, Center for Teaching Innovation, Cornell University

Fall 2021 Teaching Assistant, Social Statistics (undergraduate and graduate), Prof. Barum Park

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Cornell University

2023 – 2024 Student representative, Graduate Student Admissions Committee

Fall 2023 Brownbag presenter: “Writing a dissertation prospectus and qualifying paper”

Fall 2023 First-year professional seminar presenter: “RAing and making time for your own research”

2020 – 2021 Sociology Graduate Student Association (SGSA) Recruitment and Mentoring officer

Disciplinary

Reviewer for *American Journal of Sociology*, *Demography*, *Social Science Research*, *Sociological Methods and Research*, *Socius*, *Spatial Demography*, *Chinese Journal of Sociology*, *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*, *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*

2025 RC28 Summer Meeting at UCLA section chair “Wealth, Wages, and Well-Being”
PAA section chair “Contextual, Institutional, and Policy Determinants of Intergenerational Mobility”

2024 ASA Sex and Gender section roundtable “Gender and the Economy” presider

2023 ASA IPM (Inequality, Poverty, and Mobility) section mentor match program committee member

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

American Sociological Association, Population Association of America, International Sociological Association
Research Committee on Social Stratification 28 (RC28), International Chinese Sociological Association (ICSA)